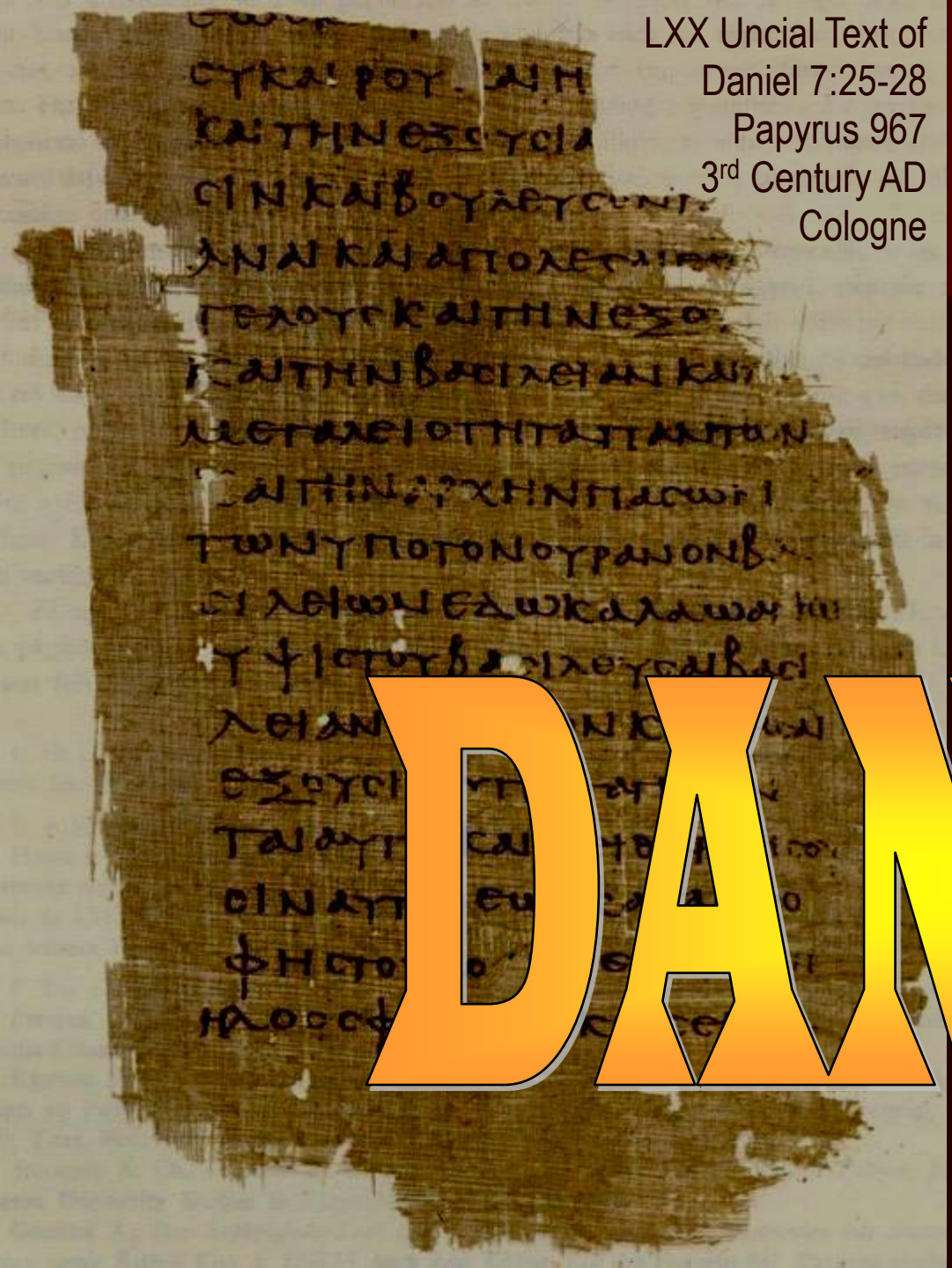

LXX Uncial Text of
Daniel 7:25-28
Papyrus 967
3rd Century AD
Cologne

Book of DANIEL

The Millennial Views

What is the "kingdom" of God? (e.g., Da. 2:44)

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The various millennial views arose in the attempt to integrate major emphases in the Bible:

- *The Old Testament promises of Israel's restoration, the return to the land, and the revival of David's kingship*
- *The messianic expectations in Jewish apocalyptic*
- *Jesus' proclamations about the kingdom of God being "at hand"*
- *The emergence of the Christian church in which the barrier between Jew and non-Jew is removed*
- *The vision of an entirely new order described as "reigning with Christ for a thousand years"*

HISTORIC PREMILLENNIALISM

Premillennialism is the view that the millennium will follow the second coming of Christ.

The kingdom cannot be consummated by human effort apart from the return of the Lord.

Prophecies of the consummation in both OT and NT should not be spiritualized.

- Chiliasm (post-apostolic church)

- Viewpoint revived in the 19th & 20th centuries
- Inaugurated eschatology
- Already/not yet tension
- Post-tribulational
- Two resurrections (just and unjust)
- Consummation of the kingdom within history
- Possible future salvation for natural Israel
- Revelation 20 describes a literal period of Christ's rule with his saints on the earth

AMILLENNIALISM

Amillennialism sees the period of the church as the millennium.

The biblical vision of the millennium is a symbol in apocalyptic language used to described the spiritual reality of the kingdom of God.

- Developed by St. Augustine in *The City of God*, 5th century AD
- Eschatological language is highly symbolic

- The OT promises to Israel are fulfilled spiritually to the church
- The posterity of Abraham is the body of Christians who make up "spiritual" Israel
- The land promises are fulfilled in the "better country", i.e., heaven
- The temple promises are fulfilled in the "spiritual house" built from living stones
- The second coming of Christ is always imminent
- Revelation 20 describes Jesus' victory in the cross

POSTMILLENNIALISM

Postmillennialism believes the church will successfully preach the gospel so that the larger part of the world will become Christianized.

After a long "golden age" of Christian civilization, during which evil will be reduced to negligible proportions, Christ will return.

- Developed out of the optimism within post-Reformation Christian Europe

- The prophets speak of God's kingdom as universal
- Jesus taught (in his parables) that the coming of the kingdom would be gradual, not cataclysmic
- The great commission is both a task and a promise
- Advancements toward the "golden age" are already evident in medicine, education, culture, economic well-being and Christian media.
- Revived in modified form by 20th century evangelicals

DISPENSATIONAL PREMILLENNIALISM

Dispensationalism views the millennium as a literal thousand year reign following the second coming of Christ.

All the promises about Israel in the OT must be taken literally, not symbolically.

- Developed by John Darby in the early 19th century (England)
- God has two distinct peoples, Israel and the church

- The kingdom was offered to Israel by Christ, but when the Jews rejected it, the kingdom was postponed
- A third temple will be built
- Christ's return will be in two stages separated by the tribulation period
- There are three resurrections (church, Israel, the doomed)
- OT land promises will be fulfilled literally in Palestine during the millennium

PROPONENTS

HISTORIC PREMILLENNIALISTS

Papias
Justin Martyr
Irenaeus
Tertullian
Frederic L. Godet
I. H. Marshall
W. J. Erdman
G. R. Beasley-Murray
J. Barton Payne
George Eldon Ladd
Robert Mounce
Robert Gundry

POSTMILLENNIALISTS

Daniel Whitby
Jonathan Edwards
Charles Hodge
A. A. Hodge
Augustus Strong
W. G. T. Shedd
B. B. Warfield
Loraine Boetter
Oswald T. Allis
R. J. Rushdoony
Gary North
R. C. Sproul

AMILLENNIALISTS

Augustine
Eusebius
Martin Luther
John Calvin
Abraham Kuyper
G. C. Berkouwer
Louis Berkhof
William Hendriksen
E. J. Young
Phillip Mauro
Anthony Hoekema
Leon Morris

DISPENSATIONALISTS

John N. Darby
Lewis S. Chafer
Donald Barnhouse
M. R. DeHaan
H. A. Ironside
John Walvoord
Gleason Archer
Charles Feinberg
Norman Geisler
J. D. Pentecost
Hal Lindsey
Charles Ryrie